Teaching prompting with the Prompting guide

A ready-to-run 75-minute session for any class, team or workshop. No coding needed; the Colab notebook is optional.

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What participants get

They describe a task in plain words. The Prompt Coach names the kind of task, picks the 3 best of 14 prompting techniques, and rewrites the task as ready-to-paste prompts. Participants learn the techniques by seeing them applied to their own work.

Three ways to use it

Way	Set-up	Best for
1. Any chatbot	Copy Prompt_Coach_Instructions.txt into ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or Copilot as the first message.	Everyone, in two minutes
2. Your own assistant	Upload Prompt_Coach_Claude_Skill.zip as a Claude Skill, or paste the instructions into a Custom GPT or a Gemini Gem.	Daily use at work
3. Colab notebook	Open Prompting_Guide.ipynb in Google Colab with a free Gemini API key. It also saves a PDF report.	Classes that want to see the code

The 75-minute session

Time	Activity	What happens
0-10 min	**Warm-up**	Everyone writes a one-line prompt for a real task from their work, runs it, and notes what is wrong with the answer.
10-25 min	**The 14 techniques**	Walk through the four families: show, do not tell; make it reason; shape the answer; talk and improve. One live example per family.
25-45 min	**Prompt Coach**	In pairs, paste the Prompt Coach into any chatbot, give it the warm-up task, and compare the three rewritten prompts.
45-60 min	**Before and after**	Run the original and the best rewritten prompt side by side. Score both with the rubric and share the biggest jump.
60-75 min	**Make it yours**	Save the coach as a Claude Skill, Custom GPT or Gemini Gem. Each person leaves with one assistant and one improved prompt.
After class	**Optional**	Run the Colab notebook on a task of your choice and submit the PDF report it creates.

Before-and-after rubric (score each 1 to 3)

Criterion	Question to ask	Original	Rewritten
Relevance	Does it answer the real need?		
Specificity	Is it tailored, not generic?		
Format	Is it in the shape you can use?		
Accuracy	Are facts and numbers right?		
Effort to fix	How much editing before you can use it?		

Exercises by job

Give each table a task from their own field. These are typical picks; the coach may choose differently for the exact wording.

Job	Plain-words task	Typical techniques	Tip
Marketing	"Write three Instagram captions for our new running shoe."	Few-Shot, Persona, Contrastive	*Paste two past captions in your brand voice so the model copies the style, not a generic one.*
Sales	"Help me prepare for a first call with a hospital's procurement head."	AI Interview, Persona, Thought Provocation	*Let it ask about the account first, then have it play a sceptical buyer.*
HR and hiring	"Draft interview questions for a junior data analyst."	Structural, Persona, Iterative Refinement	*Ask for a table: competency, question, what a good answer sounds like.*
Finance	"Explain why our gross margin fell this quarter, using these numbers."	Chain-of-Thought, Structural, Self-Consistency	*Make it show the arithmetic, then check the answer two ways.*
Operations	"Write a process for handling customer returns in our stores."	Step-by-Step, Structural, Iterative Refinement	*Numbered steps with an owner and a check at each step.*
Strategy and consulting	"Should we expand into Tier-2 cities next year?"	Tree of Thought, Thought Provocation, AI Interview	*Compare three entry options, then ask it to argue against the one you like.*
Teaching and training	"Make a 10-question quiz on supply-chain basics."	Structural, Few-Shot, Persona	*Show one good question so all ten match its level and format.*
Students and job seekers	"Improve my CV for a product analyst role."	AI Interview, Contrastive, Iterative Refinement	*Let it ask about your projects before it rewrites a single line.*

Discussion questions

- Which technique changed the answer the most for your task, and why?
- When would a plain zero-shot prompt be good enough?
- Where did the AI ask you a question you had not thought about?
- What should never be pasted into a public chatbot at your workplace?

Safe-use reminders

Do not paste confidential, client or personal data into public tools. Check facts, figures and citations before using an answer. Keep your API key private: in Colab, paste it when asked or store it under Secrets, never in a shared cell.

Files in this kit

- **Prompt_Coach_Instructions.txt**: paste into any chatbot, or into a Custom GPT or Gemini Gem
- **Prompt_Coach_Claude_Skill.zip**: upload to Claude as a Skill
- **Prompting_Cheat_Sheet.pdf**: the 14 techniques with a template for each, on one page
- **Prompting_Guide.ipynb**: the Colab notebook (Gemini), writes a PDF report
- **Sample_Output_Web_Series.pdf**: a worked example of the report
- **Facilitator_Guide.pdf**: this guide